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London Ambulance Unison Branch Committee Meeting

12th October 2019 1030hrs – Conference Room

Present: Eddie Brand – Branch Secretary
Tim Stephens – Branch Chairperson
Brian Robinson – Treasurer/East Central Sector
Samad Billoo – Equalities Officer
Mark Belkin – Education Officer/Private Members Officer
Peter Hannell – Labour Link Officer
John Gough – Retired Members Officer
Rob Sydney – Communications
Paul Stewart – H&S Officer
Julie Cunnane – Welfare Officer/North East Sector
Paul Chiddington – West Sector
Paul Ray – North East Sector
Tracy Ward – North East Sector
Steve Johnson – South West Sector
Marie Randall – South West Sector
Zaf Sardar – EOC
Jane Radley – East Central Sector
Terry Stubbs – North West Sector
Marcus Davis – Central Sector
Tim Fisher – Central Sector

Apologies: Sarah Hardy
Paul O'Neill
Claudette McNaughton
Jane Radley
Gemma Taylor
Phil Thompson
Jacqueline Mohaci

Introductions and Apologies

TS welcomed everyone to the meeting and noted the above apologies.

Tribute to Robbie Muir

TS sadly reported that Robbie Muir, an EMT from Romford, has passed away. Robbie was a much loved colleague and a big supporter of our Branch and Union. He had many friends on the Branch and he will be sorely missed. This has been a tragic year for Romford and our thoughts go to Robbie's family and many friends and colleagues across the service.

Previous Minutes

Minutes from the previous meeting were agreed as a true record with the following amendments;

Matters Arising

None

Branch Secretary's Report (EB)

Legal report and running total of compensation distributed. No new forms this month. Compensation totalling £12,065 has been awarded to LAS Unison branch members since July 2019 meeting.

£3,149,339.91 of compensation has been obtained by the branch on behalf of its members since March 1999.

(EB) Agreed to continue with affiliation to the Palestine Solidarity Campaign for £25 per year

(EB) Discussed AGM and notice period.

(EB) Request for Committee members to help distribute Unison merchandise.

Branch Officer Reports

Health & Safety (PS)

Immunisations:

The Flu Vaccination Campaign has now finished. With a total of 72% for the whole of the service being vaccinated. In line with the target set by NHSE for those staff that are 100% Patient facing, the service hit a target of 78%. The Service have a stock of around 1000 doses left over so are still able to deliver the vaccine if staff require it. Could all reps encourage staff to have it done if not already. Regarding the amount of doses available and left over from the campaign, the service have been looking at other organisations to donate them to, and not necessarily other NHS Trusts. One of the ideas is the Royal Navy, who are very interested, and discussions relating to this are ongoing.

Lateral Flow Asymptomatic Testing is now available for staff. These kits can be obtained from your management teams. Anyone wishing to do these tests should be 90 DAYS post a Positive CoVid test. I would recommend members to access this testing. They are done a couple of times a week prior and post a run of shifts and are easy to do (I have been doing them for a couple of weeks now). This will assist in keeping people at work, and those who have a Positive result from the risk of spreading it throughout the service to colleagues and patients alike.

Regarding the Covid -19 Vaccination, the Service are working on Two Plans.

One, a Partnership Plan- working with assisting delivering the vaccine in the community. Three Paramedic staff on restricted duties have been placed within a GP Surgery in the NC Sector to assist with administering vaccines.

Two, an Internal Plan- delivering the vaccine in-house for all our staff.

Due to the logistical issues regarding the Pfizer/BioNTech vaccine, having to be stored at - 70 degrees, the service will not be using this vaccine. And so the vaccine of choice will be the Astrazeneca Vaccine. This vaccine may be delivered to the Service by the end of December. Vaccines will be administered at a Centre (TBA), rather than on busses as done with the Flu Vaccine. No Dates have been set as yet. 100% Patient facing staff will be the first priority.

A Comms Bulletin relating to the Pfizer/BioNTech Vaccine is due immanently.

Covid-19:

The Infection Prevention Control & Decontamination Group (IPCD) met on the 15/12/20. I raised concerns regarding Social Distancing due to the consolidation of stations raising the risk of infection being spread I have asked for this to be formally escalated to the Infection Prevention Control Committee (IPCC) as a concern of staff side. This will be done by Claire Brown, head of IPC.

No report received from Health, Safety & Security regarding station Covid-19 Secure/Compliance, although constantly chasing them for this. There is a plan to complete System Safety Risk Assessments (SSRA) by the end of the year. This has been requested to be put back to January due to REAP 3 and the difficulties of the H&S Reps being involved.

Due to the C2 figures in the NE Sector being bad, VP are reinstating the vehicle cleaning at Queens Hospital with immediate effect.

FFP3:

The latest figures received are as follows:

Fitted on D mask: 94% of which 88% successful.

Fitted with 7500 (mask we had before): 232.

Issued powered respirator: 61.

Facial hair: 24

The FFP3 Task & Finish Group now meet on a monthly basis and is led by the HS&S Dept.

FRSM Masks:

An issue was raised at the IPCD meeting regarding Operational staff accidentally using the NON Fluid Repellent Surgical Masks (FRSM) for patient facing duties (Datix raised). These are for Corporate/admin staff only, although they have been placed in Messrooms for staff to use when on station, the boxes should be clearly marked to this effect.

I have asked for this practice to be stopped to mitigate the risk of staff wearing the wrong surgical masks whilst carrying out their patient facing duties, due to the fact they are very similar in colour. Staff should only be wearing the FRSM (Type 11/11R) masks for patient

facing duties. Please remind all members of this fact. If this does happen then a Datix should be raised.

Equalities (SB)

- Meetings are being arranged with various minority groups
- Proposing organising a 'faith forum' to discuss recruitment panels.
- SB has been invited to take a seat on an 'Equalities' Board with the Chief Executive.

Education (MB)

- Functional Skills courses are still in huge demand. Unclear if the service are going to fund.
- ePCR rollout causing problems. Cited example of 17 colleagues who requested a 'refresher' but have yet to be paid. MB will take to OPF.
- NQP Grievance – Collective grievance submitted on behalf of NQP's who have had previous LAS Clinical experience but face fast-tracking restrictions.

Communications (RS)

- Update your details forms to be sent out to sectors soon. Form is also available on the website. Reminder that application forms now come in 2 colours – Purple for members who wish to pay subs via Docas (Salary) and Green via Direct Debit.
- Unison 'newsfeed' now reinstated following the elections for General Secretary.

Retired Members (MA)

No Report

Labour Link (PH)

No Report

Membership (PC)

- Membership continuing to grow. 60% of LAS permanent staff are Unison Members.
- Unison members under 30years old make up 31% of total membership
- Gender equality for both LAS workforce and Unison membership with 50% even split between female and male.
- Well done to CM (Individual Recruitment) and MS (Course Recruitment) who recruited most new members in 2020.

Treasurer (BR)

Accounts and any outstanding claims need to be submitted before 31st Dec.

Private Ambulance Members (MB)

No Report

Welfare (JC)

- Busy period with some lower paid members needing financial support. Sometimes due to payroll issues.

Fleet (BB)

No report

Staff Council

No report

Senior Sector/Area Representatives Reports**East Central (BR)**

No Report

Central (MD)

No report

North West (PH)

- Health and Safety Rep has stood down
- Wembley has now been closed
- NETS are moving to Kenton
- FRU 'End of Shift' Trial has started

South West (SJ)

- Assaults on colleagues increasing. Will give guidance to all SW members including details of the new 'Violence Reduction' Officers.
- Body Worn Cameras. Trial to begin soon.
- Some stations are changing their rotas to similar pattern to the 'Covid Support' rota.

EOC/EOC H&S (SB & ZS)

- Relocation of Bow EOC causing concerns for a variety of reasons; Lack of consultation, Loss of Inner London (although protected for 2 years), poor transport links, parking and canteen facilities.

West (PC)

No Report

North East (JC)

- Pressure from Management to reduce 'Job Cycle Times' despite growing problem of handover delays at Queens, Romford.
- Romford has been designated as the first 'Super-Station'. No site has been identified.

Central (MD)

No Report

AOB

EB thanks all for hard work and dedication in what has been a difficult year.

Date of Next Meeting
22nd January 2021 at 1400-1700
viaTEAMS